INDIVIDUAL CENTRED LEADING AND THE ROLE OF THE LEADER

WELCOME

Welcome to this British Athletics - Leadership in Running Fitness Course - Individual Centred Leading and the Role of the Leader

OBJECTIVES

By the end of this module, you should be able to:

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- The relationship and roles of British Athletics, the Home Country Athletic Federations and local running networks.
- Why people become leaders, their role and qualities.
- The motivations and benefits of running.
- About the barriers to participation and how to overcome them.
- About individual centred leaders, inclusive leading and the athlete development module.
- The differences between runners and how to lead young runners.
- About the session safety and how to conduct risk assessments.

INTRODUCTION TO THE RUNNING FAMILY

Let's introduce you to the running family.

British Athletics:

Are the National Governing Body of the sport, responsible for the Olympic and Paralympic programmes and coaching qualifications.

The Home Country Athletic Federations:

England Athletics, Athletics Northern Ireland, Scottish Athletics and Welsh Athletics -

Are responsible for local running programmes, supporting runners at every level. Delivery of Coach Education Qualifications and Coach Development opportunities.

WHY DO PEOPLE BECOME A LEADER?

Have you ever thought about why people become leaders? Take a few minutes to reflect about the reasons why you became a leader.

Below are some of the motivations for people becoming leaders.

- To share the enjoyment of running with others
- To achieve personal ambition
- To meet people
- To encourage people into athletics
- To earn money

Now we've taken a look at some of the reasons why people become leaders, let's take a look at the role of a leader.

ROLE OF THE LEADER

We're now going to take a look at the role of the leader in running.

- They organise and promote the group
- They provide a safe and inclusive environment with activities at the right level for the participants
- They encourage and maintain involvement in running and walking
- They signpost runners to development opportunities
- They ensure good sportsmanship
- They need to be ***individual centred*** leaders.

MOTIVATIONS AND BENEFITS OF RUNNING

Let's take a look at why people get involved in running.

- Reduces risk of coronary heart disease (CHD), cancer, stroke, type 2 diabetes, high blood pressure and osteoporosis
- Increases muscular efficiency
- Helps you to enjoy better sleep
- Gives you more energy
- To meet people and make friends
- Sense of freedom
- Can increase emotional well-being and confidence
- Decreases levels of stress, depression and anxiety
- Helps with weight loss and weight management

There isn't a set correct order as this is down to a person's individual health differences and lifestyle experiences

BARRIERS TO PARTICIPATION

Have you ever stopped to think what puts some people off running? Many of the barriers to participation can fall into these four categories:

- Psychosocial factors
- Culture
- Socioeconomic factors
- Impairment

Have a go at identifying two barriers for each of the four categories.

Let's see how your answers compare with our list of barriers for each category:

For Psychosocial factors, the barriers may include:

- self esteem
- family issues
- low expectations of self or by others
- time
- body image
- competition
- peer pressure
- intimidated by others
- afraid of getting injured

For culture, the barriers may include:

- gender of leader or group
- group dress
- perception of the sport
- day and time of group
- religion
- sexual orientation
- pregnancy

For Socioeconomic factors, the barriers may include:

- health concerns
- cost
- family
- venue
- safety

For impairment, the barriers may include:

- physical
- learning
- hearing loss and deaf
- impaired sight and blind
- accessibility of venue
- equipment

Take some time to reflect on your own group or club. Could there be any local barriers to participation? For example, is your group welcoming to all? How was your first experience at your group or club?

You may find it helpful to complete the Disability Inclusion Training and a link to this can be found in the resources section.

OVERCOMING BARRIERS

Now we've taken a look at all the possible barriers, do you know what types of things you can do to overcome them?

Do you think the following statements are **true** or **false**.

- Have different types of leaders to reflect the groups
- Have a safe welcoming venue
- Have a variety of gender groups to meet all needs including mixed and gender specific
- Have marketing materials to reflect all people
- Have inclusion/inclusive practices
- Have strict rules
- Set a strong lead pace, it will help runners improve if they have to keep up
- Adapt activities to ensure no-one gets left behind

The false statements are 'Have strict rules' and 'Set a strong lead pace, it will help runners improve if they have to keep up'.

INDIVIDUAL CENTRED LEADERS

Do you know what we mean by individual centred and what this means in practice?

An individual centred leader would:

- Place the **needs of each individual** before the interests of the leader or the group
- **Encourage** individuals to be involved in their own development and empowered to take greater responsibility for it
- Ensure all individuals are **welcomed** to participate, are valued and encouraged to explore their own potential
- Recognise the importance of providing a **fun and safe** environment.

INCLUSIVE LEADING

So how would you go about ensuring you deliver inclusive sessions? You need to **think inclusive**.

- Welcome and include each athlete
- Talk to the athlete about their needs, motives and interests
- Establish the runners preferred style or language of communication
- Focus on their ability
- Adapt your coaching style, communication skills and coaching activities
- Seek advice, if necessary.

Inclusive leading is important for all runners, however it's particularly important for runners with disabilities to ensure they have the opportunity to participate. Disabilities may be physical, sensory, intellectual or long-term health issues.

You may find it helpful to complete the Disability Inclusion Training and a link to this can be found in the resources section.

AN INDIVIDUAL CENTRED APPROACH TO LEADING

We'd now like you to take a little time to reflect about individual centred approach. Write a few sentences about a time when you have:

- Experienced an individual centred approach.
- Been individual centred in your own running group or another activity.

Thank you. Here are some examples about an individual centred approach to leading from other leaders.

- Run leaders arranging loopbacks at set points, so the group largely stays together, but all runners can run at their own pace.
- Run leaders using time, rather than distance to set up hill runs.

- Pairing new runners with a buddy.
- Asking questions about the individual's motivations for running, previous/current sport experience and any fears or questions about running.

ATHLETE DEVELOPMENT MODEL

Let's take a look at the Athlete Development Model and how it relates to Individual Centred Leading.

Athletes at the fundamental stage focus on ABC's – agility, balance, coordination and also push, pull, rotate, hinge, squat and lunge. Whether an athlete is 12 years old or an adult, they'll need to gain, maintain and develop the fundamental skills in order to progress.

Those at the foundation stage focus on technical development for running, jumping and throwing. To run efficiently, throwing and jumping correctly is important in developing the physical robustness required to run.

Athletes at the event group running stage focus on speed, running over obstacles, endurance, wheelchair racing and physical preparation.

Those at the event specialism stage focus on events ranging from 5k to marathon running.

A performance athlete is someone at the highest level in the sport, for example, an athlete on an Olympic programme.

Take a moment to consider the stage most of the runners in your group belong to. Many runners may lack ABC's, so remember it's important to provide individual centred practice and consider how to include those activities in your warm-ups.

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN RUNNERS

We'd now like you to take a look at this image, make a note of the differences you observe between the runners in the picture?

Well done. Let's see how your answers compare with ours. This image shows differences in height, physical development, posture, maturation, technique and possible differences in joint integrity. Other less visible differences could be psychosocial development and motivation for running.

It's important to take into consideration the developmental and chronological age differences for runners when planning sessions. For example, one runner maybe older, but not as developed as a younger runner. Therefore, it is your responsibility with the guidance of a suitably qualified coach to ensure training activities are developmentally appropriate, particularly with young athletes.

LEADING YOUNG RUNNERS

When leading young runners, aged 12-18 years old, there are the following additional safety considerations:

- Parental consent is required
- The ratio of leaders to runners
- Avoid roads and never use roads at night. Use parks, cycle-ways and fully lit areas
- All runners are to wear reflective bibs
- Keep to distances/sessions suitable for the age of the youngest or least able runner
- Seek the advice of a suitably qualified coach to confirm your sessions are appropriate for the needs of the runners.

For additional information, please refer to the post course resources available through MyLearning.

PHYSIOLOGY

Did you know that children's physiological development 'stop-starts'?

Some of the facts.

- 3-6 Years (pre-school) – there's rapid physical growth and brain development.
- 6-12 Years (school aged) – there's slow physical growth and steady brain development.
- **12-17 Years (adolescence and puberty) – there's rapid physical growth. Initially rapid and then steady brain development.**
- 17+ (early adulthood) – there's slow physical growth and steady brain development.

PHYSIOLOGICAL DIFFERENCES BETWEEN YOUTH AND ADULTS

Do you know what some of the physiological differences are between youth and adult runners? Have a go at selecting which of the following statements are true for the young runner.

- Their energy system composition is different
- Their heart and respiratory rates are higher
- Their muscle contains much less creatine phosphate and less glycogen, and consumes glycogen more slowly than an adult's muscle
- Their heart and respiratory rates are lower
- Their skeletal structure differs - bones are still growing
- Their energy system is fully developed

Here are the correct answers.

- Their energy system composition is different
- Their heart and respiratory rates are higher
- Their muscle contains much less creatine phosphate and less glycogen, and consumes glycogen more slowly than an adult's muscle
- Their skeletal structure differs - bones are still growing.

The topics mentioned in this section will be covered in more detail in the Preventing injuries module and the Factors that affect performance module.

PHYSIOLOGICAL CHALLENGES AND TRAINING

Are you aware of some of the specific physiological challenges you are likely to encounter with teenage runners? They may encounter:

- Bone injuries.
- Osteoporosis.
- Changes in body fat (females may increase and males may decrease).

Now you are aware of the *Physiological differences between youth and adults, what does it mean to you as a leader of running activities for 12-18 year olds?* Below is a list of what type of training is appropriate for young runners.

- Avoid high volume.
- Hold back on high intensity interval training until after puberty.
- Instil the ethos of 'speed play' through fartlek (continually varied). Keep it 'light' working the Aerobic and Alactic energy systems. For athletes in the foundation stage, the duration of the fartlek could be 5' - 15', while in the event group development stage it would usually be something between 10' - 20' duration.
- Include lots of fundamental movements (including ABC's) and skill activities.
- Include variety and keep it fun.

For more information on this please refer to the Athletics Hub/My Learning.

Please remember, that when working with 12 to 18 year olds, where possible, your session content should be approved by a suitably qualified coach (athletics coach,coach in running fitness or level 2 and above coach).

SESSION SAFETY TASK

Let's take a look at session safety. We would like you to think about any session you have been involved in. Using the three boxes provided, record the things you think a leader needs to do:

- Before the session
- During the session
- After the session

Well done. First you should look at what goes into the Plan for the session.

Next you will then deliver the session.

Finally, you should review the session, considering what went well and what you will do differently next time

During each stage it's important to include: safety, organisation, instruction, explanation and demonstration. We'll next take a look at each of these stages in a bit more detail.

So let's compare our thoughts with yours by taking a look at each of these stages in a bit more detail.

PLAN SESSION

Let's take a look at the **plan** stage in a bit more detail. Before any session you must:

- Plan the route and session, by considering individual needs and safety

- Conduct a risk assessment, in order to identify hazards and try to reduce the risk to an acceptable level or eliminate it altogether
- Ensure you know your group and their capabilities
- Create a contingency plan
- Have safety measures in place

RISK ASSESSMENT PROCESS

Let's take a closer look at the risk assessment process and safety measures.

- Risk assessment process
- Risk assessment task
- Plan safety measures

Why don't we take a look at the risk assessment process, which you need to complete before any session.

First of all you must identify any hazard. Then ask yourself can the hazard be reduced to an acceptable level or eliminated.

If the answer is yes, you are able to proceed. If the answer is no, then you next need to assess the degree of risk.

Is it low, medium or high? If the risk is low you can proceed. If the risk is medium or high, you must assess if you can reduce the risk to bring it into the low category. If this isn't possible, then do not proceed!

So what type of hazards might you encounter? Here are just some examples:

- Busy roads
- Poor running surfaces (slippery or uneven)
- Poorly lit areas
- Poor weather conditions
- Individual athletes' factor such as health conditions.

RISK ASSESSMENT TASK

Let's take a look at a risk assessment scenario. You are planning for a session along the pavement of a busy road and a member of your group is visually impaired. We would like you to complete a risk assessment for your session. You have identified crossing a busy road as a hazard for this runner. Think about the answers that apply.

Can the hazard be eliminated?

Is the degree of risk low medium or high?

Can the hazard be reduced to bring the risk into the low level?

How can you reduce the risk level? Write down your answers.

Let's see how your answers compare to our suggestions. The visually impaired athlete may need:

- a well-lit area
- a guide
- reflective clothing in front of them may be easier to follow
- change the location to somewhere less busy
- an agreed emergency safety instruction or command.

In this particular scenario the risk only applies to one runner. Other times you may identify risks that apply to the whole group or only applicable to certain ability groups. Regardless of the numbers at risk, it's the leader's responsibility to lower risk levels, in order to proceed.

Remember that risk assessments are dynamic and you should always be checking safety, throughout all of your session.

You should make visual risk assessments whilst out on your planned route and immediately act on any risks that you identify.

PLAN SAFETY MEASURES

When planning your session you should take these safety measures.

- Count your group
- Check the kit - reflective, layers, shoes
- Carry phone, sugar snack, water
- Have a system to identify hazards, for example, the call back system
- Have a plan to manage injuries and illness
- With consent and considering personal data compliance, have a point of access to personal medical details and contact numbers. For example, ask runners to carry an ICE card (In Case of Emergency card) with them.

It's important to consider all of these measures, so that your sessions are a safe as possible.

DURING SESSION

Let's take a look at the '**do**' part of your running session, in other words the things you should **do during** the session itself.

- **Warm-up** (always)
- **Main session**
  - running fitness
  - activity
  - skill
  - competition
- **Cool-down** and basic stretches (always)

- Endurance
- Speed
- Strength
- Flexibility
- Coordination.

Warm-up

You must **always warm-up** first as this helps prevent injuries and prepares the mind and body ready for the main session.

Main Session

Then you start the **main session** which should include:

- running fitness
- abc activity
- skill
- an element of fun like a competition.

Cool-down

You should always conclude the session with a cool-down, including static stretches, to help the body recover and to its pre-exercise state.

Throughout all of these sessions it's very important to include these components of fitness. These will be covered in more detail in the Performance Factors Module.

- endurance
- speed
- strength
- flexibility
- coordination.

REVIEW SESSION

Let's take a look at final part of the process The following are the actions you should complete after your session. Let's learn about the review actions.

Learn from the runners and leader's experiences by asking:

- How did you find the intensity of the session?
- What could I do to adapt the session for any of your individual needs?
- How could I make the session more fun?
- How did you find my session organisation and instructions?

Advise runners of activities they can do during the week
Advise runners of next week's session.
Check runners safely out of your care.
Make notes for yourself.
Plan the next session.

That finishes our look at '**plan, do, review**'

ATHLETE DEVELOPMENT MODULE EXAMPLES

Let's take a moment to revisit the Athlete Development Module. We'll take a look at what might go in a session for foundation stage children, beginner adults and foundation stage adults. For some of the activities mentioned, you can find more detailed information in the resources.

Foundation children

Warm up: Games such as 'dishes and domes'

Main session: Fitness activities such as, 'raid the goal', 'shark tag or pairs running and relays'

Cool down and stretches: Jog to walk and stretches of legs, arms and trunk.

Beginner adults

Warm up: Brisk walk, arm circles, high knee march, side steps, gentle jog for 1-2 minutes

Main session: Balance activities, walk/jog in single file for up to 10 minutes

Cool down and stretches. Brisk walk to walk and stretches of legs, arms and trunk.

Foundation adults

Warm up: Jog, arm circles, running high knees, sumo squats, walking lunges, skipping, strides

Main session: Fitness activity, such as 'meet and retreat' or 'out and back runs'

Cool down and stretches: Jog to walk and stretches of legs, arms and trunk.

Now take a look at the task cards in the resources.

QUALITIES OF A GOOD LEADER

Let's take a look at the qualities of a good leader. Select the words that you think describes a good run leader.

- Knowledgeable
- friendly
- patient
- understanding
- supportive
- approachable
- punctual
- arrogant
- honest
- inclusive
- non judgemental
- encouraging
- bossy

Here are the correct answers.

- Knowledgeable
- friendly
- patient
- understanding
- supportive
- approachable
- punctual
- honest
- inclusive
- non judgemental
- encouraging

As a leader this automatically makes you a role model. What you do and how you behave will influence the group. You should aim to be a good motivator by being individual centred and understanding the motivations of all the runners.

Please take some time to reflect on your own skills and qualities, and what makes you a good run leader.

CONGRATULATIONS

Congratulations! You have now finished this British Athletics - Leadership in Running Fitness Course – Individual Centred Leading and the Role of the Leader

You should now be able to understand:

- The relationship and roles of British Athletics, the Home Country Athletic Federations and local running networks.
- Why people become leaders, their role and qualities.
- The motivations and benefits of running.
- About the barriers to participation and how to overcome them.
- About individual centred leaders, inclusive leading and the athlete development module.
- The differences between runners and how to lead young runners.
- About the session safety and how to conduct risk assessments.

Thank you and goodbye.